

TRUNKBELAY · CALCULATION NOTE

TrunkBelay sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Source	docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	First issue at TRL 3, on the constructable design of TKB-DDR-002

TrunkBelay sizing calculations

On paper, the constructable TrunkBelay collar locks on every trunk from 200 to 450 mm with a locking factor of 1.54 or more, holds the 2.5 kN load of R1 with every steel part at 2.1 times yield or better, and lets one rescuer lower a 100 kg person 25 m with about 80 N at the brake hand. Its weak points are friction, mass and cost: the lock rests on an assumed friction on wet bark that must be measured first, the kit weighs 8.9 kg against a 5 kg target, and it costs USD 758 against a USD 100 per-kit target. Every figure below comes from `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`, which imports the parametric model (`cad/src/model.py`), so the sizes here are the sizes in the STEP file, the drawings and the build plan. Tags in square brackets ([A1], [B4] ...) match the script output and `results.csv`.

These are first-principles screening estimates for a paper proof of concept. They do not replace a proof test of the collar on cut palm trunk sections or a timed drill, which are TRL 4 work.

Safety: TrunkBelay holds and lowers a person at height. These numbers are for a design review only. The kit is not certified rescue or fall-protection equipment, and nobody is lowered with it before the collar has been proof-tested at 2.5 kN on cut trunk sections and the drill has been run with a dummy at low height.

■ 1. Assumptions

Table 1. Assumptions.

#	Assumption	Value	Basis
1	Design person	100 kg, plus 0.96 kg of triangle, sling and carabiner	TKB-REQ-001, R2 and R5
2	Static load the collar is sized for	2.5 kN (R1)	TKB-REQ-001, R1
3	Friction on wet coconut bark	Rubber pad 0.5; webbing-sleeved chain 0.4	Judgement for rubber and nylon on wet fibrous wood; first item to measure (TKB-DDR-002, A1)
4	Lever height	The chain line above the bottom edge of the bars, 160 mm (conservative: the bars bear at their bottom edge as the frame cocks)	Model
5	Pad rubber	60 to 70 Shore A, compression modulus 6 MPa, contact patch 40 mm wide on a round trunk	Rubber class
6	Steel	S355, yield 355 MPa; fillet welds 290 MPa allowed (E7018)	BOM lines 1 to 5
7	Chain	6 mm grade 80: working load limit 11.2 kN, minimum breaking force 45 kN, 0.80 kg/m	Catalogue class
8	Rope	11 mm EN 1891 type A: at least 22 kN, 65 % at a figure-eight loop, 4 % stretch from 50 to 150 kg, 78 g/m	Standard minimum and catalogue class
9	Descender	Rope friction 0.2 over 540 deg of contact (ratio 6.6)	Conservative; confirm with the maker's data
10	Carabiners	Aluminium, class B, 25 kN on the long axis, 85 g	EN 362 class
11	Bark	No cut below 2 MPa under rubber; the outer coconut stem is far stronger in crushing	Judgement; inspected at TRL 4 (R8)

■ 2. Loads [A]

- [A1] Holding a 100 kg person, the collar carries 0.99 kN. The R1 load of 2.5 kN is 2.5 times that.
- [A2] If slack is left when the feet are freed, the person drops onto the rope. On 1 m of rope a 30 mm drop gives about 2.6 kN, 50 mm 2.9 kN and 100 mm 3.4 kN. The drill takes all slack through the descender first, so the drop stays under 30 mm; the strength factors in section 4 cover the small excess over 2.5 kN.

■ 3. Grip on the trunk [B]

The collar is self-locking. The load hangs from the load eye at a distance e from the trunk axis; the chain holds the frame at a height h above the bottom of the bars. Taking moments, the bars press the bark with a force $N = W e / h$ and the chain presses the far side with the same force. Friction at both places holds the frame if (friction at the pads + friction at the chain) $\times N$ is at least W , that is if the combined friction is at least h / e . The ratio of the friction available to the friction needed is the locking factor. It does not depend on the load: the grip rises in step with it.

Table 2. Grip at the R1 load of 2.5 kN.

Trunk	Load line from the axis	Friction needed	Locking factor	Bars press (each pad)	Chain tension
200 mm [B1]	273 mm	0.58	1.54	4.3 kN (2.5 kN)	3.3 kN
300 mm [B2]	331 mm	0.48	1.86	5.2 kN (3.0 kN)	4.2 kN
450 mm [B3]	418 mm	0.38	2.35	6.5 kN (3.8 kN)	5.5 kN

- [B4] The smallest locking factor is 1.54, on the smallest trunk. The friction of the chain's full wrap round the trunk is extra and is not counted.
- [B5] Under 2.5 kN the pads squash about 3.1 mm (1.9 MPa) and the chain seats up to 2.9 mm; the frame drops about 10 mm as it cocks, inside the 20 mm of R1.

The lock depends on assumption 3. If the combined friction on a wet 200 mm trunk were below 0.58, the collar would slide. Measuring it is the first TRL 4 task.

■ 4. Strength at the R1 load [C]

- [C1] Bearing bars, RHS 50 x 25 x 2.5: 0.48 kN m at the spine on the 450 mm trunk, 171 MPa, factor 2.1 on yield (5.3 at the working load).
- [C2] Bar-to-spine fillet welds, 4 mm all round: 82 MPa, factor 3.5.
- [C3] Spine arm: 8 MPa beside the lightening hole. The load eye is 13 mm thick with its doubler rings; bearing under the carabiner bar is 19 MPa and the tear-out strength 75 kN, 30 times the R1 load.
- [C4] Chain cleat at 5.5 kN of chain tension: the 5 mm web beside a slot, loaded by the next link, 113 MPa (factor 3.1); the twist between the two slots, 0.16 kN m, gives 54 MPa in the cheeked top (factor 3.8 in shear).
- [C5] Chain: 5.5 kN at most, factor 8.1 on its breaking force and under half its working load limit; 2.2 kN at the working load.
- [C6] Rope: about 14 kN at the figure-eight loop, factor 5.7 at the R1 load and 14 at the working load. Carabiners: factor 10 and 25.

■ 5. Lowering [D]

- [D1] The descender's friction ratio of 6.6 and the 180 deg turn over the brake carabiner (1.87) leave about 80 N at the brake hand for a 100 kg person, inside the 150 N of R5. Without the brake carabiner the hand would hold about 150 N, at the limit, which is why the brake carabiner is part of the design.
- [D2] A 25 m lowering at 0.3 m/s takes 83 s and turns 24.8 kJ into heat: 85 % in the descender, 7 % in the brake carabiner and 8 % at the hand. If the descender kept it all it would warm by at most 44 K.

TrunkBelay: energy turned to heat lowering a 100 kg person 25 m, kJ
(TKB-CAL-001 estimates)

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/trunkbelay

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION

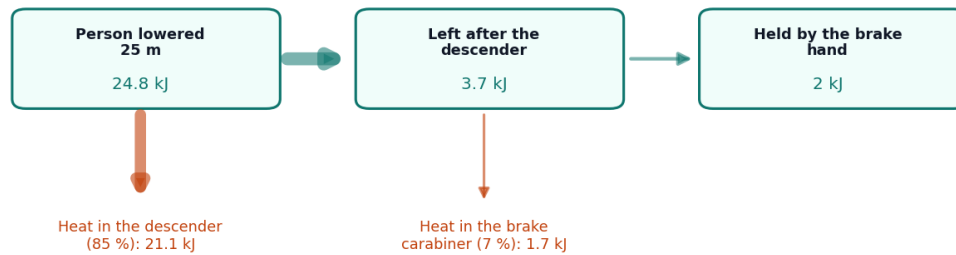


Figure 1. Energy turned to heat lowering a 100 kg person 25 m (estimates).

■ 6. Fit, reach and rigging [E]

- [E1] Rope: 25 m of lowering, 1 m from the descender to the person at the start, 1.5 m for the knots and 0.5 m round the brake carabiner: 28 m of the 30 m.
- [E2] Fit: on a 200 mm trunk the chain loop is 769 mm, the pads touch 58 mm along their faces and the spine is 23 mm clear of the bark; on 300 mm, 1,086 mm, 87 mm and 31 mm; on 450 mm, 1,563 mm, 130 mm and 43 mm. The 110-link chain leaves at least 10 links of tail on a 450 mm trunk.
- [E3] Rigging time once the rescuer is in position (estimate): collar 60 s, descender and rope 40 s, bag to the ground 20 s, triangle and chest sling 120 s, clip in and take in slack 30 s: 4.5 minutes.

■ 7. Mass [F]

- [F1] Collar frame 2.55 kg (2.26 kg of it steel), chain set 1.88 kg, descender 0.53 kg, carabiners 0.26 kg, rope 2.34 kg, triangle and sling 0.87 kg, bag 0.45 kg.
- [F2] The whole kit is 8.9 kg if carried up the trunk.
- [F3] If the helpers haul the rope, bag, triangle and sling up on a 4 mm tag line, the rescuer carries 5.5 kg; an aluminium frame (6082-T6, 40 % thicker) saves about 1.2 kg; both together leave 4.4 kg.

■ 8. Bark [G]

- [G1] At 2.5 kN the pads press 1.9 MPa (0.7 MPa at the working load) and the sleeved chain 0.6 MPa: no cut is expected. Bare links outside the sleeve press about 8 MPa on a 3 mm line and may mark the bark; R8 is confirmed by inspection after the TRL 4 tests.

■ 9. Cost [H]

- [H1] Value-engineering target: USD 900. Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 758 (USD 142 under the target).
- [H2] Against R9 (parts per kit) the kit is over the value-engineering target of R9 by USD 658. The largest lines are the auto-locking descender (USD 280), the evacuation triangle (USD 140), the rope (USD 105) and the bag (USD 45).

■ 10. Results against the requirements

Table 3. Requirements on paper.

ID	Status on paper	Basis
R1	Met on paper; friction to confirm	Locking factor 1.54 at the smallest trunk; settles about 10 mm [B4, B5]
R2	At risk	The single top chain cannot hold an upward pull on paper; the drill keeps the collar above the person's attachment so the case does not arise
R3	Met	200 to 450 mm, no tools [E2]
R4	At risk	About 4.5 minutes, a thin margin on a rough estimate [E3]
R5	Met on paper (estimate)	About 80 N at the hand [D1]
R6	Met	28 m needed of 30 m [E1]
R7	Not met	8.9 kg carried [F2]
R8	Met on paper; to confirm	Pads 1.9 MPa, sleeve 0.6 MPa [G1]
R9	Not met	USD 758 a kit [H2]
R10	Cannot be shown on paper	Needs the training trial at TRL 4

The requirements not met or at risk (R2, R4, R7 and R9) are set out with options and a recommendation for Amish in the design decisions register (TKB-DEC-001).